

Workplace Violence Management Policy

Introduction:

Workplace violence is more commonly seen in health care settings than in many other workplaces. This phenomenon affects employees across the health care organizations. The workplace violence prevalence is usually under-reported and difficult to be estimated. This occurs due to various reasons including staff shortage, high rate of morbidities, lack of policies and training, long waiting time, overcrowding and exposure to violent individuals.

Scope:

This policy applies to all Royal Hospital employees.

Purposes:

- Provide workplace violence pathway to the employees.
- Guide employees on workplace violence prevention strategies.
- Protect employees from all forms of violence.
- Alert employees of violent behaviors.
- Encourage reporting all violence cases in the incident reporting and learning system (IRLS).
- Assess the risk of workplace violence at Royal Hospital.

Employees' rights:

The Omani penal code highlights the penalty of employee violence (code 191) as follows:

- Assaulting or threatening employees in the workplace is penalized with not less than one month in prison and not more than one year. The aggressor is charged with fine of not less 100 Omani Rials and not more than 500 Omani Rials.

Procedure:

When the workplace violence occurs, the senior employee witnessing the event shall:

1. Call Code white (Emergency Response Team) on 9111.
2. Take appropriate action to stabilize the situation to ensure safety and prevent further injury.
3. Assess the surrounding environment to identify risks and escape routes.
4. Assess the situation prior taking further intervention.

5. Support individuals involved in the violence incident.
6. In case of physical violence, the individual involved shall head to the Emergency Department for examination and treatment.
7. Incident report to be documented in the Incident Reporting and Learning System (IRLS) within 24 hours of the assault.

Roles and Responsibilities:

Director General

1. Ensure the effectiveness of the workplace violence management system.
2. Receives reports of workplace violence rates at the organizational level.

Directors and Heads of Departments:

1. Ensure the implementation of workplace violence policy.
2. Assess and identify risk factors of workplace violence and act on the appropriate actions to mitigate any possible risks.
3. Ensure education and training is received by all employees at the departmental level.
4. Ensure the ability of all staff to deal with Workplace violence.
5. Sustain efficient work practices and communication skills.
6. Guide and support assaulted staff to seek medical treatment or psychological support if required.
7. assist the assaulted individual to report violence cases.
8. Investigate and act on all Workplace violence cases.
9. Document actions taken post investigation in the Incident reporting and learning system.
10. Implement Workplace violence pathway.

Event manager/Quality Professional

1. Forward all workplace violence to the concerned director for action.
2. Provide quarterly reports to the directors on workplace violence.

Health, Safety and Environmental officer

1. Yearly departmental workplace violence risk assessment to be conducted for the entire hospital departments.

2. Assess the workplace areas with high rate of workplace violence.
3. Provide quarterly reports to the Quality and patient safety department with action plans.
4. Ensure all employees of Royal Hospital receive training and education on workplace violence.
5. Collaborate with directors, heads, focal points and employees to achieve safe workplace environment.
6. Conduct annual employee survey to assess workplace violence.

Legal Department

1. Investigate and resolve unsettled conflicts between individuals involved in the violence event.
2. Guide employees on the appropriate pathway to be followed from legal perspective.
3. Monitor Workplace violence events that reach legal department and provide quarterly reports to the Director General of the hospital.
4. Ensure all employees are trained on their rights and responsibilities in terms of legal aspect.
5. Provide legal opinion on workplace violence cases.

Security Guard

1. Protect employees, visitors, attendants, and all hospital property from hazards.
2. Respond promptly to all workplace violence events.
3. Ensure prevention of all forms of harm to all individuals at the Royal Hospital, promote safe environment and monitor hospital operations.

Patient Services Officer

1. Respond promptly to all workplace violence events.
2. Communicate to the Royal Oman Police when required.
3. Monitor workplace violence cases.

Education and Training Department:

1. Ensure workplace violence training is available to all employees.
2. Monitor compliance of workplace violence employee attendance.

3. Provide quarterly report to the DG office on workplace violence training progress.

Hospital employees:

1. Attend workplace violence training
2. Report workplace violence events.
3. To be Aware of the policy/procedure/system of workplace violence.
4. Communicate effectively with employees and patients to avoid any conflicts.

Recommended policies related to workplace violence are available at the document management system:

- Workplace violence events' pathway
- Workplace violence preventive strategies
- Code white policy
- Workplace violence risk assessment tool

No.	References
1.	Guidelines for preventing workplace violence for healthcare and social service workers, OSHA, 2016
2.	Workplace Violence Policy & Procedure, Al Massara hospital, 2019